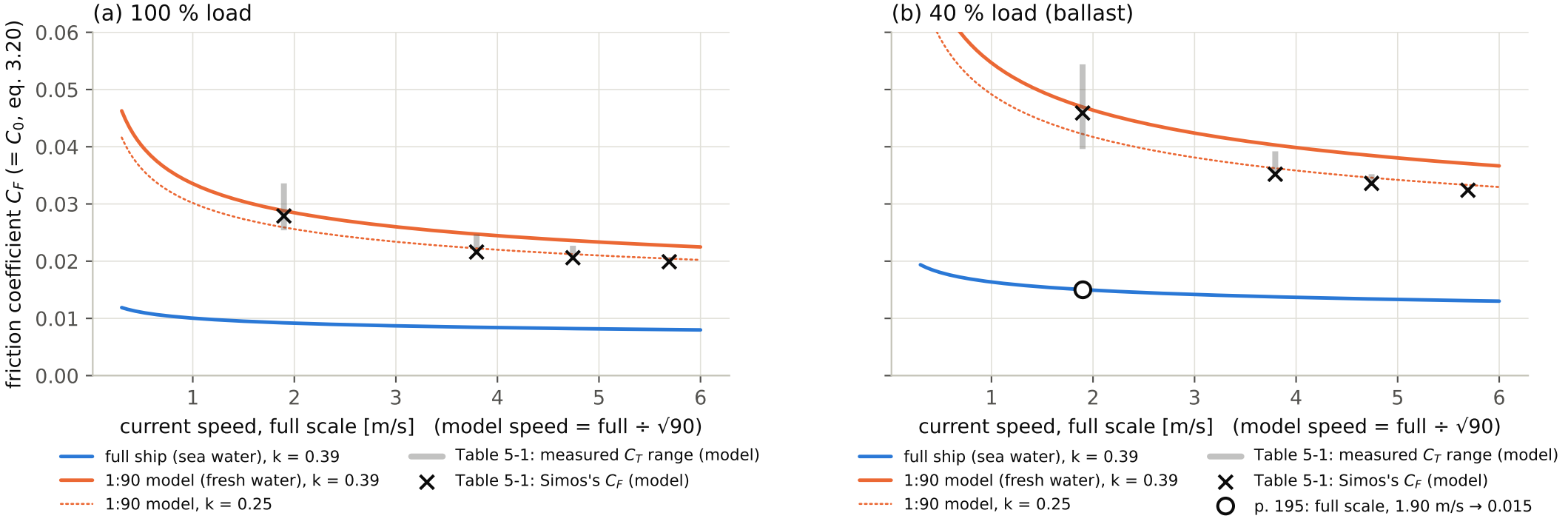Faster current → larger Reynolds number → less friction. Model tests (small Re) have more friction than the real ship.